

by George

Vaishali Narkar and Sanjeev Khandekar

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By George

The exhibition *By George* probes the evolving landscape of surveillance and perception in a digitized, hyper-connected world. Drawing on the legacy of George Orwell's prophetic visions of authoritarian watchfulness, the show reframes the panopticon not as a remote dystopia but as an immediate, insidious presence. The title, a pun on both British exclamation and Orwell's name, sets the tone for an investigation into how surveillance, once limited to state apparatuses, now permeates everyday life—through architecture, social media, and the devices we carry.

The curatorial framework poses a central, unsettling question: Who is watching, and how does that gaze alter our behavior, our freedom, and our very sense of self? The bathroom in a mall becomes the unlikely ground zero of such inquiry. Surveillance is no longer solely a matter of government control; it has morphed into “dataveillance,” as corporations harvest and monetize our digital footprints with increasingly aggressive precision.

Vaishali Narkar & Sanjeev Khandekar's *Live Auto Icon* – b.1984 is an incisive portrait of Mark Zuckerberg, the emblematic figure of our age's data economy. Rendered through mixed media and sandblasted glass, the work echoes the idea of the 17th-century philosopher Jeremy Bentham's “auto-icon”—a preserved body as legacy—by making Zuckerberg a metaphorical heir to the Panopticon. Born in 1984 (the year of Orwell's novel), Zuckerberg becomes an accidental oracular subject. The piece critiques the ideological foundation of platforms like Facebook, where transparency masquerades as connectivity, and privacy becomes obsolete. The personal is no longer private—it is product.

In the *Parallax View* series, Vaishali & Sanjeev shift the focus from individuals to systems of vision and distortion. In *Parallax View I*, a grid of windows—a seemingly mundane apartment façade—masks the blurred edges between observer and observed. The symmetry is deceptive; the emptiness behind the panes hints at absence, decay, and perhaps even intrusion. The scene is eerily quiet, and the viewer begins to question whether they are the watcher or the watched.

In *Parallax View II*, the narrative fractures further. The panoramic sweep of disconnected rooms and interiors becomes a meditation on fragmented realities and mediated perceptions. The viewer is offered glimpses, never a full picture. What appears coherent at first glance disintegrates upon closer inspection. The piece reflects the social and psychological consequences of constant observation: the parallax of truth itself, contingent upon angles and algorithms.

Together, these works expose how visual and digital surveillance has reshaped human subjectivity. They confront the ways in which data capitalism conflates voyeurism with utility, and how our own complicity often goes unexamined. In this ‘desert of the real’—as the artist notes—the gaze is no longer just oppressive but performative. We live in anticipation of being seen, categorized, and interpreted.

‘*By George*’ for the artists & its viewers is not merely an art exhibition. It is a cultural MRI scan of our shifting epistemologies, as the politics of vision extend beyond state control into the commerce of the self. As public and private merge, and every digital trace becomes a potential dossier, Vaishali & Sanjeev's works invite us to ask: What is privacy when our images are always already circulating? What is seeing, when algorithms shape our eyes? In this age of infinite windows—be they browser tabs or surveillance feeds—*By George* reminds us that transparency is often a trap disguised as light.



Title : The Parallax View I

Medium: Mixed media & sand blasted glass on canvass

Size: 36" X 53.5"

Year: 2010